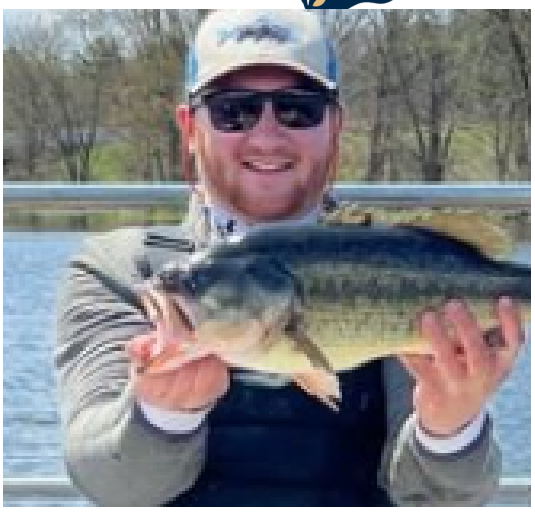
# BIOLOGY COLLOQUIUM SERIES | FALL 2026



## Connectivity as a transferable framework to understand food web function across aquatic ecosystems

**Thu, October 22nd**
**2:00 – 3:00 PM**
**MSB 105**


**Dr. Justin Lesser**
Florida International University / Institue of Environment



Through foraging, habitat use, and trophic interactions, consumers both respond to and mediate the effects of environmental drivers and stressors, shaping patterns of energy flow, community structure, and ecosystem function across spatial and temporal scales. By integrating approaches from community ecology, spatial analysis, and quantitative modeling, this work demonstrates how ecological principles developed in one system can be applied to generate predictive understanding in others, particularly in large, spatially complex ecosystems where key processes are often difficult to observe directly. Together, these perspectives provide a general foundation for understanding how environmental change propagates through food webs and influences ecosystem function. More broadly, this work highlights the value of crosssystem synthesis for identifying general ecological rules and improving our ability to anticipate and manage ecosystem responses to changing environmental conditions


**case.fiu.edu/about/directory/profiles/lesser-justin.html**